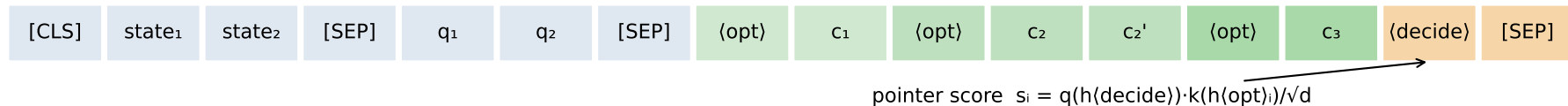
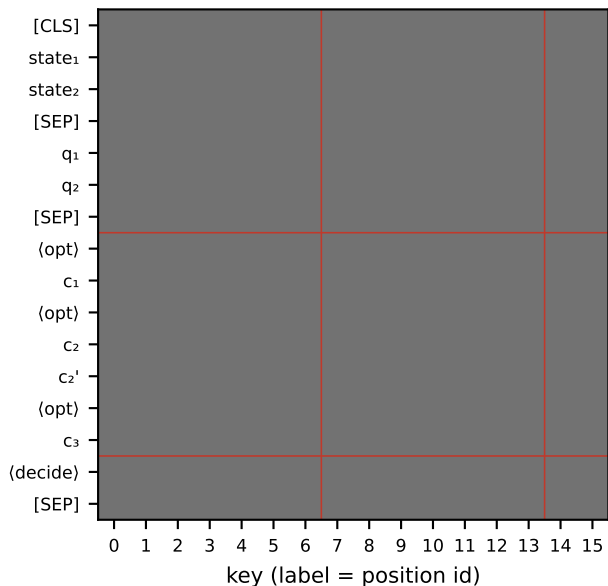


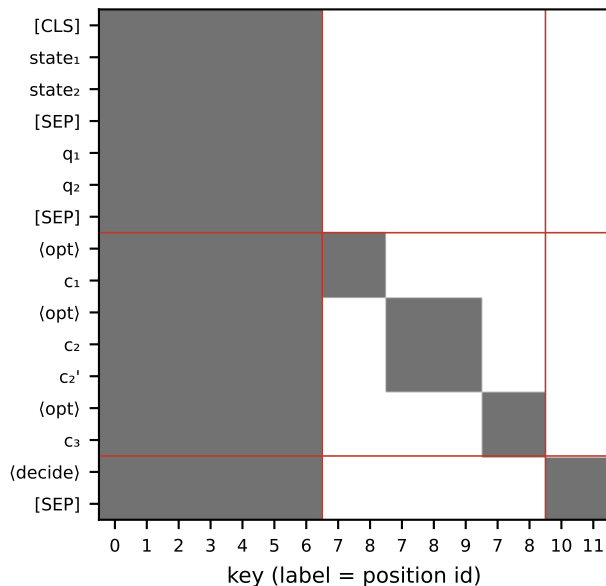
(a) joint sequence: prefix (state, question) · candidate blocks, each opened by a $\langle \text{opt} \rangle = [\text{MASK}]$ marker · $\langle \text{decide} \rangle = [\text{MASK}]$



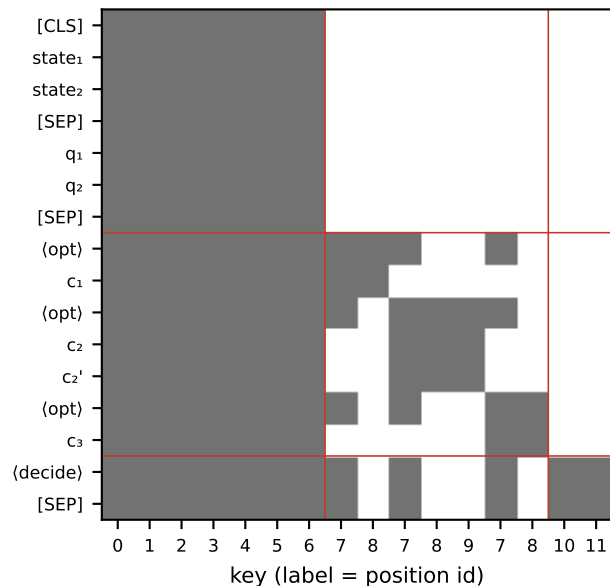
seq: sequential positions, full attention



pointwise: tied positions, block-diagonal



set: pointwise + $\langle \text{opt} \rangle \leftrightarrow \langle \text{opt} \rangle$, $\langle \text{decide} \rangle \rightarrow \langle \text{opt} \rangle$



(b) attention masks (dark = attends); position ids on the x axis. Under the tied layouts every candidate block starts at position P and $\langle \text{decide} \rangle$ sits at $P + B$, whatever K.